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(b) Discuss the paleoanthropological reconstructions of culture of Homo Erectus

Homo erectus is an extinct species of genus Homo.

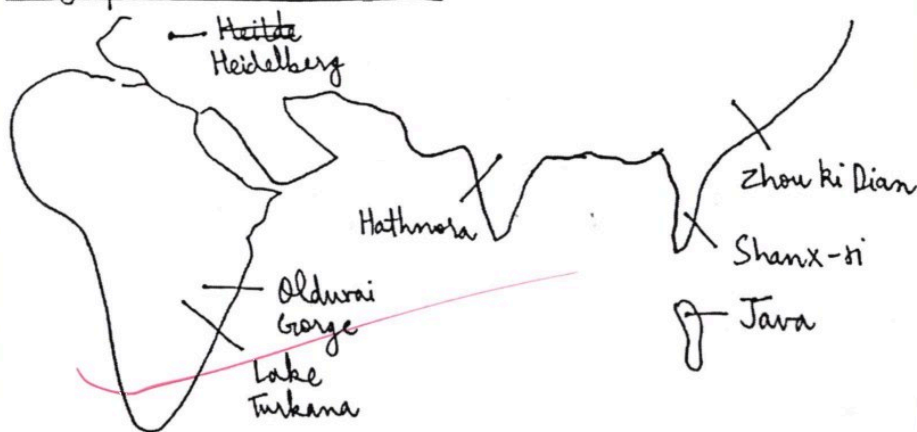
Discovery: By E. Dubois in Java (1892) in form of cranium and femur.

Time span: (2 mya - 0.2 mya) [mya: million yrs ago]

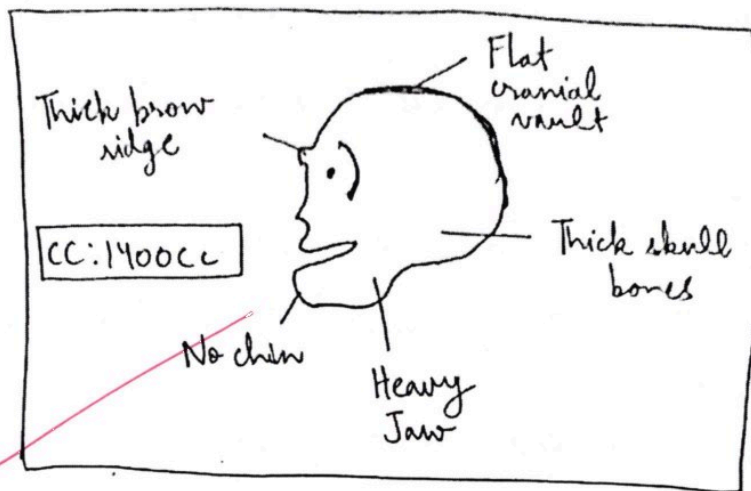
Sub species

- (i) H. erectus erectus
- (ii) H. erectus pekinensis
- (iii) H. erectus narmadensis
- (iv) H. erectus heidelbergensis

Geographical Distribution



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Fig: Erectus skull.

Cultural Features

- 1) Tool making: Abbevillian and acheulian culture both are associated with Homo erectus. Tools included chopper chopping tools, hand axe, & cleavers.



Abbevillian
hand
axe



Acheulian
handaxe



cleaver

2) Hunting

- At Ambrona-Toralba in Spain, bones of elephant were found.
- At Zhoukudien and Kenya bones of big bones of skull found along with tools

3) Language

- Presence of motor muscle in cerebral cortex and presence of sylvian fissure
- Pilbeam (1990): These factors may have helped erectus to develop some form of communication through language.

4) Use of fire

- Direct evidence found at Swarthkrans (South Africa) of charred bones which are 1 million yrs old.

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Need to add
few analytical
points in re-constructing
the culture

Scanned with CamScanner

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5) Rituals

- Evidence found at Pech la Adze (Spain) of two lines drawn on bison rib along with erectus skull. This indicates towards presence of some form of culture.

Hence, emergence of culture among Homo erectus was a significant in human evolution. Scientists argue that domestication of fire by erectus was a huge leap which help in making us advanced species - Homo sapiens ultimately.